السلطان الاعظم – effectively appropriating his older brother's title while referring to him with none. See also Chapters 3 and 4.

14. For brief descriptions see Ball 2008: 190–193, 240–246 (including Bust); for additional maps, plans, and bibliography cf. Ball 2019: Nos. 149, 358, 685; and for a summation of the extant evidence, see Thomas 2018: 59–60, 125–127, 132–135.
15. Upon being pursued by Chinggiz Khan in *c.*1220, the Khwarazm-shah Jalal al-Din's (r. AH 617–628/1220–1231 CE) recourse to Ghazna – his appanage, where he rallied troops – drew the Mongols there, where he defeated advance Mongol forces. There was destruction at Ghazna due to the confrontation, including the killing of its inhabitants and destruction of its *jami'*; but ultimately the Khwarazm-shah fled toward the Indus and the Mongols annihilated his forces on its banks in late 1221 (Jackson 2017: 80, 159, 165). Thus, it is unclear whether Ghazna would have received "more savage treatment than the vengeful Ghurid ruler 'Ala' al-Din Husayn *Jahan-suz*" had visited upon the city in *c.* AH 544/1150 CE (*ibid.*, 180). But even after Chinggiz Khan looked to new conquests beyond Afghanistan, the remaining bands of Negüderi or Qara'unas – former contingents of Mongol forces – held the entire territorial swath from Zabulistan (including Ghazna) eastward into the upper Indus valleys in their apparently lawless grasp until the early fourteenth century, making it a "no man's land." Cf. *ibid.*, 148, 183, 195, 197; also Bernardini 2020.
16. Prior to the 1950s and the beginning of Italian surveys and excavations in the Ghazna region, and the French archaeological activity in the vicinity of Bust-Lashkari Bazar, A. Godard had done initial photographic documentation at Ghazna in the 1920s, as seen in DAFA archives at the Musée Guimet, Paris (access kindly granted by M. J. Ghèsquiere, July 2018). J-C. Hackin's archive of the 1930s–1940s provided photographs of Bust and its environs: cf. *Lashkari Bazar* (1978): planches 42, 46. See also Ball, Bordeaux et al. 2019: 403.
17. For the two episodes of fiery destruction at Lashkari Bazar, see Schlumberger 1978: esp. 31, 37, 41; Sourdel-Thomine 1978: 21, 29, 36, 39, 54; Ball and Fischer 2019: 473; cf. also *infra* in main text. For the post-Mongol abandonment of Bust, see Allen 1988: 55, 56.
18. See *supra* in notes for Lashkari Bazar. For signs of destruction at Ghazna, see *supra* in notes for Mongol and post-Mongol impacts; also Bombaci 1966: 5ff.; Scerrato 1959: 52; Scerrato 1962: 265–266; Giunta 2005: 474ff.
19. See above in main text, and Chapters 1 and 3 for southward expansion by the Shansabanis of Firuzkuh, after the burning and destruction of Ghazna and Lashkari Bazar by 'Ala' al-Din *Jahan-suz* (AH 544/1150 CE).
20. Scerrato 1959: 49–52; also Thomas 2018: 126–127.
21. The initial association of the palace and Mas'ud III began with Bombaci's study of a marble fragment found in the modern *ziyarat* on the western perimeter of the palace mound: the fragment consisted of the top portion of a pointed arch with semi-circular lobes within, carrying an inscription of Q. II: 256 (the Throne Verse) along with the *kunya* and *laqab* of the sultan (cf. Bombaci 1966: 33ff., 9–20). Bombaci already questioned whether "the palace was really built by Mas'ud III, or was only readjusted by him." Recent re-examinations of the excavation records indicate that the palace's